GOLDEN FIR SOLUTIONS

Master Report Center Complete User Guide

Version 2.0.2

Windows 10 / Windows 11

Split Reports | Consolidate Reports | Synchronize Reports | Lookup Data

Professional Excel reporting and data workflow tools

Automate - Simplify - Empower

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1. System Requirements and Performance

Master Report Center is a Windows desktop application designed for Excel-based reporting and data workflows.

- **Windows 10 or Windows 11**
- **Microsoft Excel Desktop**
- **Internet access** for purchase, activation, recovery, refund requests, and licence-status synchronization.

> Microsoft Excel Desktop is required because several workflows use Excel COM automation to preserve workbook structure, formatting, worksheet protection settings, and other Excel-native behaviour.

Performance

Processing speed depends on the computer, Excel version, workbook size, formulas, formatting complexity, file location, antivirus scanning, available memory, and storage speed. Large workbooks may run noticeably faster on a higher-performance office computer than on a home PC.

- Keep sufficient free disk space available.
- Avoid editing the same workbook while MRC is processing it unless the module specifically requires the currently open Excel view.
- Prefer local or fast network storage when possible.
- Allow Excel background processing to finish before starting another large task.

2. Installation and Startup

Standard Installer

Recommended package:

```
Master_Report_Center_v2.0.2_Setup.exe
```

The installer creates the application installation, Start Menu integration, and normal Windows uninstall support.

Portable Build

Alternative package:

```
Master_Report_Center_v2.0.2_Portable.zip
```

Extract the entire ZIP before launching Master Report Center.exe. Do not run the executable directly from inside the ZIP archive.

Local Application Data

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\GoldenFir\MasterReportCenter\\
```

Runtime state is stored outside the application installation folder. Reinstalling the application does not automatically remove local trial or licence state.

3. Trial, Purchase, Activation and Recovery

Trial

Master Report Center includes a 12-day trial. When the trial expires, report modules are locked until a valid licence is purchased, activated, or recovered.

Licence Options

Licence	Price	Device Recovery / Rebinding
Personal License	AUD 49 one-time	Up to 4 in a rolling 12-month period
Company License	AUD 149 one-time	No annual count limit; events are still recorded

Activation

Use License > Activate License when activating an existing paid licence on the current installation. Keep the purchase email and Recovery Code in a safe place.

Recovery

Use Recover Existing Account when restoring an existing licence. A same-device restoration does not count as a new migration. A genuinely new installation identity may count as a migration under Personal License rules.

Refunded or Revoked Licences

If a refund is approved and confirmed by the payment provider, the licence is revoked. Existing reports and files remain on the computer, but MRC report modules become locked.

4. Main Application Areas

Home

Home provides access to the four report modules plus Recent Projects / recent activity, Tips & Guidance, and System Status.

License

- View trial or licence status.
- Purchase a licence.
- Activate an existing licence.
- Recover an existing account.
- Copy purchase email / Recovery Code when available.
- View Personal licence migration allowance.
- Submit a refund request when eligible.

Settings

Settings provides Configuration backup & transfer and Diagnostics. Export Configuration creates a JSON backup of supported settings. Import Configuration loads a previously exported configuration file. View Log Folder opens diagnostic logs.

About

About shows the application version, publisher, product identity, and supported workflows.

5. Split Reports - Complete Guide

Purpose

Split Reports divides one large Excel report into multiple smaller workbooks based on unique values in a selected column. Typical uses include Supplier, Department, Country, Store, Category, Team, or Status.

Supported source formats: .xlsx, .xlsm, .xls

Standard Workflow

- Select the Source Excel File.
- Select the Output Folder.
- Select the worksheet.
- Confirm the Header Row.
- Select the Split Column.
- Choose Full Workbook Data or Current Excel Workbook View.
- Click Analyze Report.
- Review row count, output count, blank split values, and filename preview.
- Set optional filename suffix and date suffix.
- Click Start Splitting and monitor Activity Log.

Header Row

Auto Detect is the default. A manual Header Row from Row 1 to Row 50 can also be selected.

Full Workbook Data

Reads all data rows from the selected worksheet. Saved filters and hidden-row state are not treated as the active processing set.

Current Excel Workbook View

Processes only rows currently visible in the open Excel workbook after filtering or row hiding. This mode must be analyzed first so MRC can verify visible-row and output-group counts.

If the source file, worksheet, split column, header row, or view mode changes after analysis, run Analyze Report again before splitting.

Protected Worksheets

Protected worksheets can only be processed through Current Excel Workbook View. Open the workbook in Excel, apply the required filters or row hiding, enable Current View, analyze, and enter the worksheet password if requested.

Worksheet passwords are used only for the current MRC session and are not saved or written to the Activity Log.

Options

- **Exclude Hidden Columns** - enabled by default. Hidden support columns required by Data Validation may be retained automatically.
- **Include Other Worksheets** - enabled by default. If disabled, cross-sheet formulas, Named Ranges, charts, or dropdown sources may be affected.

Analyze Report

- Source mode
- Worksheet and Header Row
- Split Column
- Rows / visible rows
- Column count
- Output files to create
- Blank split values
- Worksheet protection status
- Filename example

Output Naming

Output filenames can include the split value, a custom suffix, and the current date. The date suffix is enabled by default.

```
Supplier A - Testing Outstanding - 10-10-2026.xlsx
```

6. Consolidate Reports - Complete Guide

Purpose

Consolidate Reports combines multiple related Excel reports from one folder into a single consolidated workbook.

Supported formats: .xlsx, .xlsm, .xlsb, .xls

Excel temporary files beginning with ~$ and existing Combined_Report_... outputs are excluded automatically.

Standard Workflow

- Select the Source Reports Folder.
- Select the Output Folder.
- Optionally enter a worksheet name.
- Review Data Handling options.
- Click Analyze Reports.
- Confirm the Excel files found.
- Click Start Consolidation.
- Review Activity Log and the persistent Consolidate Log.

Worksheet Selection

If the worksheet field is blank, the first worksheet is used. If a worksheet name is entered, that same worksheet must exist in each source workbook intended for processing.

Header Rules

All valid source files must have the same normalized header set, but column order may differ. MRC maps columns by header name.

A source file may be skipped if required headers are missing, extra headers change the expected set, headers are blank or duplicated, the worksheet is missing, or the workbook cannot be opened.

Output Template

The first valid source workbook is copied and used as the output format template. Excel-native copy/paste is used to preserve workbook structure and formatting as faithfully as possible.

Data Handling Options

- **Ignore completely blank rows** - enabled by default.
- **Remove exact duplicate rows** - enabled by default.
- **Add source filename column** - disabled by default; useful for traceability.

Protected Template Worksheet

If the output-template worksheet is protected, MRC requests the password. Validation uses a temporary copy. During processing, only the copied output workbook is unlocked and then re-protected before saving.

Output and Log

```
Combined_Report_Merged_2026-10-10_093000.xlsx
Consolidate_Log_2026-10-10_093000.txt
```

The log includes source / output folders, worksheet, processing options, protection status, files found / processed / skipped, source rows read, rows written, duplicates removed, blank rows skipped, output file, duration, and status.

7. Synchronize Reports - Complete Guide

Purpose

Synchronize Reports uses one or more Source workbooks to update a Destination / Master workbook. It is a match-and-update workflow, not simple concatenation.

```
Match existing row -> Update selected fields -> Optionally append new rows
```

The original Destination workbook is never overwritten.

Standard Workflow

- Select the Destination workbook and Destination worksheet.
- Select the Source reports folder and Source worksheet.
- Click Analyze Headers.
- Choose one or more Match Fields.
- Choose one or more Write Fields.
- Review Add unmatched source rows and Ignore blank source values.
- Click Start Synchronization.
- Review the Updated workbook and Synchronize Log.

Worksheet Selection

Visible, Hidden, and VeryHidden worksheets can appear in the selector. The Source worksheet list is sampled from the first valid Source workbook; the selected worksheet name must exist in each source file intended for processing.

Match Fields

Match Fields should be stable identifiers such as Style Code, SKU, Employee ID, Order ID, or Certificate Number. Multiple Match Fields can be combined, for example Style Code + Country.

Fields expected to change should normally not be used as Match Fields.

Write Fields

Write Fields are values Source is allowed to write into a matched Destination row. The same field cannot be selected as both Match and Write. Updates are values-only so Destination formatting remains intact.

Duplicate Destination Keys

If Destination contains duplicate Match keys, the first Destination row wins. The duplicate-key count is reported in the log.

Options

- **Add unmatched source rows** - enabled by default. New keys can be appended as new Destination rows.
- **Ignore blank source values when updating matched rows** - enabled by default. Blank Source values do not erase existing Destination values.

Protected Destination Worksheet

If protected, MRC validates the password using a temporary copy. Only the copied output workbook is unlocked, updated, and re-protected. The original Destination remains unchanged.

Output and Log

```
MasterRegister_Updated_2026-10-10_093000.xlsx
```

```
Synchronize_Log_2026-10-10_093000.txt
```

8. Lookup Data - Complete Guide

Purpose

Lookup Data enriches a smaller Target workbook using selected fields from a larger Reference Database.

```
Large Reference Database -> Smaller Target workbook
```

The original Target workbook is never overwritten, and unrelated Reference records are never appended to Target.

Supported formats: .xlsx, .xlsm, .xlsb, .xls

Standard Workflow

- Select the Reference Database workbook.
- Optionally enter the Reference worksheet name; blank uses the first worksheet.
- Select the Target workbook.
- Optionally enter the Target worksheet name; blank uses the first worksheet.
- Click Analyze Headers.
- Choose one or more Match Fields.
- Choose one or more Return Fields.
- Review Safe Write Behaviour.
- Click Start Lookup.
- Review the Lookup output workbook and Lookup Log.

Match Fields

Match Fields must exist in both Reference and Target and identify the corresponding record, for example Style Code or Style Code + Country.

Return Fields

Return Fields come from the Reference Database and represent values to retrieve, such as Supplier Name, Department, Category, Registration Number, Status, or Expiry Date.

If a selected Return Field is missing from Target, MRC can add the missing Target field to the output workbook.

Safe Write Behaviour

- **Only fill blank Target cells** - enabled by default. Existing non-blank Target values are preserved.
- **Ignore blank Reference values** - enabled by default. Blank Reference values do not clear Target data.

Duplicate Reference Keys

Duplicate Reference Match keys are counted and recorded in the Lookup Log. Review them when Reference keys are expected to be unique.

Output and Log

```
TargetReport_Lookup_2026-10-10_093000.xlsx
```

```
Lookup_Log_2026-10-10_093000.txt
```

9. Data Safety and Recommended Practice

- Keep an original copy of important workbooks.
- Review Header Analysis / Report Analysis before large tasks.
- Use stable identifiers as Match Fields.
- Read Activity Log warnings instead of assuming every Source file was processed.
- Review persistent module logs after business-critical jobs.
- Do not delete output logs until the result has been checked.
- For protected workbooks, use the correct worksheet password and verify protection on the output.

Module	Safety behaviour
Split Reports	Creates separate output workbooks.
Consolidate Reports	Builds a new combined workbook.
Synchronize Reports	Never overwrites the original Destination.
Lookup Data	Never overwrites the original Target.

10. Common Warnings and Troubleshooting

Microsoft Excel is required

If MRC reports that Microsoft Excel or pywin32 is unavailable, confirm that Microsoft Excel Desktop is installed and working normally on Windows.

Excel is busy

MRC automatically retries certain temporary Excel COM busy conditions. If the computer is heavily loaded, allow Excel to finish background work and retry.

Processing is slower than expected

Possible causes include large row/file counts, complex formatting, formulas or external links, protected worksheets, slower CPU/storage, limited memory, network-drive latency, antivirus scanning, and other Excel processes.

A slower runtime does not by itself indicate incorrect processing. Use Activity Log and output logs to confirm completion and row/file counts.

Header mismatch

Check that required files use the expected fields. Column order can often differ, but missing, extra, blank, or duplicate headers may cause a file to be skipped or analysis to fail.

Worksheet not found

Confirm the selected worksheet name exists in the workbook. For Consolidate and Synchronize, the selected Source worksheet must exist in each relevant Source workbook.

Protected worksheet password rejected

Confirm the worksheet password in Microsoft Excel. MRC does not save worksheet passwords.

Output appears incomplete

Review the persistent module log for skipped files, unmatched rows, duplicate keys, blank values ignored, rows removed as duplicates, or visible-row-only processing.

11. Understanding the Four Modules

Module	Main Purpose	Source	Result
Split Reports	Divide one report by a selected field	One workbook	Many workbooks
Consolidate Reports	Merge related reports	Folder of workbooks	One combined workbook
Synchronize Reports	Match and update a master	Destination + Source folder	Updated copy of Destination
Lookup Data	Enrich from a larger database	Reference + Target	Enriched copy of Target

Choose the module based on the business task rather than the number of files alone.

12. Support Information

When reporting a problem, keep the following information available:

- Master Report Center version
- Windows version
- Microsoft Excel version
- Module being used
- Approximate row count / file count
- Activity Log message
- Persistent module log
- Whether the workbook is protected
- Whether files are local, network-based, OneDrive/SharePoint-synced, or removable storage

Do not send passwords or private licence Recovery Codes in ordinary diagnostic messages.

Version Note

This guide documents Master Report Center v2.0.2 and is intended to match the public v2.0.2 release behaviour. Future versions may change controls, processing rules, licensing behaviour, or supported workflows.

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